



LUNENBURG PUBLIC SCHOOLS

FY20 Budget

**Annual Town Meeting
May 4, 2019**

FY20 School Department Identified Budget Needs: Funded, Unfunded, and Reductions

The District Leadership Team identified the essential personnel and non-personnel components necessary for the School Department to operate in an effective, efficient, and timely manner to meet the needs of all learners.

Funded, Budget Needs

Administration/District

- Central Office Secretary: This new secretary position will assist Business Office with bi-weekly payroll, Human Resource Office with filing and processing requests, Facilities and Grounds with the online permitting system and billing, IT Department with billing and Superintendent Office with special tasks and coverage. This position is a critical need. This additional staffing is needed to ensure the Central Office is functioning in an efficient, effective, accurate, and timely manner.

Teachers

- Primary School Teacher, Grade One: The current FY19 Kindergarten class has six sections and requires an additional teacher moving up to the First Grade level. Based on the current Kindergarten class size of 25, an additional Grade 1 is necessary. Without this position, next year Grade 1 class size will be 30.

Instructional Support Staff

- Primary School, five (5) paraprofessionals: These positions are associated with one to one student services and a new behavioral classroom previously funded in the substitute account.

Athletics

- Unified Basketball Coach: Unified Sports joins people with and without intellectual disabilities on the same team. It was inspired by a simple principle: training together and playing together is a quick path to friendship and understanding. In Unified Sports, teams are made up of people of similar age and ability. That makes practices more fun and games more challenging and exciting for all. Having sport in common is just one more way that preconceptions and false ideas are swept away.

Lunenburg High School was a pioneer in the implementation of one of the first unified programs in the state several years ago when the unified track was offered. That sport which has now grown in the Midland Wachusett League and through the state was only the beginning. Other districts throughout the state and in our own league have added additional unified offerings such as basketball.

The season is a 3 to 4-week season during the last week of October till the 2nd or 3rd week of November. The teams play 4-5 games and participate in a jamboree with our league schools at the end of the season. The cost to operate the program is minimal, essentially needing to fund a coach, and transportation. Another coach or I will officiate for no charge, we can either use older basketball uniforms or purchase t-shirts. The school already has everything else needed for games and practices.

Facilities & Grounds

- Summer Student Custodians, two (2) buildings: Three temporary employees are hired over the summer months to assist with cleaning of the school buildings. The facility revolving account has been the source of funding for these positions for many years. This year the revolving account can only support one of the three positions; therefore the local budget includes two student custodian positions.

Non-Personnel Expenses

- Professional Development: Professional development needs include building a positive school culture, literacy, training in the Professional Learning Communities model, social/emotional/behavioral supports, and Advanced Placement teacher training.
- Special Education Transportation: Budgeted amount includes an additional van with monitor for new student services.
- General Education Transportation: With a new contract, there is a 3.45% increase in bussing costs included in the budget.
- Out of District Tuitions: The overall \$144,000 increase is a result of one half percent anticipated increase to all tuitions as well as higher needs students placed in a more service support setting.

Unfunded, Budget Needs

Administration/District

- Director of Teaching and Learning: This position would help make progress in all eight District Strategic Plan goals as well as have a high impact on teaching and learning. The district has not had a Curriculum Director since June 30, 2012. Due to lack of dedicated leadership in teaching and learning, the district is lacking in standards-aligned curriculum maps K-8. The NEASC is requiring the High School to develop standards-aligned curriculum maps for all courses using a common district curriculum map template. Currently there is no district template.

There is a need to develop a literacy plan for the district. This work cannot be done by a Literacy Coach alone, as the role of coach is a full-time position working in classrooms with teachers.

There is a critical need for a district-level curriculum leader to have oversight of:

1. all curriculum work being done by departments at the high school or in Task Force groups to ensure a common template with the critical elements of a rigorous and robust curriculum is being utilized,
2. grants are written to support district priorities in teaching and learning,
3. foster and develop consistent use of best practice,
4. professional development in order to support those areas identified as priority need to improve teaching and learning,
5. development of district assessments that can provide needed data to determine appropriate interventions for students,
6. development of a curriculum renewal cycle,
7. creation of annual professional development plans for the district,

8. the district mentoring program,
9. Master Teacher projects that are teaching and learning based.

The district needs a district-level curriculum leader to:

1. attend meetings held by DESE in order to stay abreast of new initiatives on the horizon. This knowledge allows the district to anticipate, proactively plan, and budget for new initiatives and unfunded mandates.
2. collaborate with other districts to find areas we can share resources, optimize resources, and find ways to reduce costs for professional development.
3. work with the Superintendent and District Leadership Team to execute district goals related to teaching and learning.

Teachers

- Literacy Coach: This position was included in the budget with alternative funding source. The position will be funded with federal grant monies, if the annual allocation can support it. This new Literacy Coach position is needed to provide expertise in literacy instruction as the district begins to design a strong literacy program districtwide, but particularly in K-5. Teachers are going to need in-district expert support as they make this transition. Literacy development is vitally important, particularly in K-3. The Literacy Coach will be able to assist teachers in design of effective whole class lessons, as well as interventions for struggling readers and writers.
- Teachers and Paraprofessional: A determination will be made in July and August 2019 if additional staff are needed based on possible increased enrollment this summer.
- Instructional Technology Specialist Teacher/Coach: This position would provide job-embedded technology professional development and technical support for teachers in the classroom. This support may be in the form of researching instructional technology tools and applications, co-planning with teachers, providing technical assistance during a lesson, and designing and facilitating technology workshops for teachers after school.

Athletics

- Coaches, Middle School: These positions are associated with an anticipated expansion of the Middle School athletic program, should the recommendation for expansion be approved by School Committee this spring and paid by student fees.
- Associate Coaches: Ten (10) Associate Coaches were not funded at this time.
- Athletic Trainer: Athletic Trainers benefit the following:
Coaches- Full-time athletic trainers are uniquely qualified to facilitate 360-degree communication between the coach, the athlete (and/or their parents) and if applicable the athlete's physician. In the morning the AT can communicate with the physician on the athlete's progress, get feedback from the athlete during their lunch break and email their status to the coach before an afternoon practice. This circle of communication not only provides full transparency during the student's healing process but also gives the coach the time necessary to plan a day's game or practice based on the student's participation status. Another advantage enjoyed by coaches with full-time athletic trainers on staff is the ability to focus solely on coaching. In some situations, the coach's role expands to overseeing athletic injuries after completing first aid training, placing

them under undue stress and unnecessary risk of liability. With an athletic trainer on staff, the coach can put all their energy into helping the team succeed.

Athletic Directors- In an increasingly litigious society, it is more important than ever to keep detailed records. In an area as sensitive as student health, who better to maintain and update these records than an athletic trainer who sees these students every day? These records may include Pre-participation physical and evaluation results, student-athlete interaction and rehabilitation notes.

Parents- Parents not only benefit from the injury prevention services of athletic trainers but also their injury rehabilitation services. With a full time, athletic trainer at their child's school, parents do not need to take off work to for their child's physical rehabilitation appointment and save money on those associated costs. Of course, if the parent has a preferred rehabilitation provider, the athletic trainer can work with them when rehabilitation is complete to make sure the student is effectively transitioning back into participation.

Students- Athletic trainers have the student athlete's best interest mind. Athletic trainers want to see students excel on the field, but never at the cost of putting themselves at an unnecessary risk of injury. It is the athletic trainer's job to ensure that the student-athlete has the best possible high school athletic career while keeping them healthy for their future, in sports or otherwise.

Budget Reductions, Impact Statements

Teacher Reductions

THES Enrollment Bubble Teacher to LMS: A grade 7 teacher will be switched to grade 6 to accommodate the larger class size (138). This will make six grade 6 teachers. The past several years we have had 6- 10 new sixth graders register over the summer.

Grade 7 will function with 5 full-time teachers. Student enrollment is currently 131, making class sizes approximately 26 per class (1 with 27).

Foreign Language Teacher: This would be an elimination of an LMS program developed over the past two years in which students are exposed to three languages and different cultures in order to make a more informed decision on which foreign language they want to take in grade 8.

This is a true reduction of educational programming for students. LMS will run 6th and 7th grade specials and enrichment with one less offering, making enrichment class sizes larger (average: 28-29).

Instructional Support Staff Reductions

Paraprofessional, Study Hall: This will impact the LHS Advisory program. We will not be able to mandate the Thursday 24-minute activity which is the heart of the advisory program. Staff will simply be supervising students in study halls. This impacts teacher planning and making connections with students.

Greenhouse Manager (part-time): There would no longer be small group activities in the greenhouse. Other staff and students would assume the responsibility for watering and caring for the plants.

Athletic Staff Reductions

Athletic Trainer (proposed new position): The district will not have an athletic trainer on staff. The district will attempt to contract available athletic trainers in the local area at a per diem rate when possible. The department will continue to provide the safest environment within the means available to the student-athletes. The position is going to be a requirement by the state for all athletic departments at some point in the near future. This position is vital to help provide an even safer environment for the students who participate in athletics.

Non-Personnel Reductions

Paraprofessional Staffing: A reallocation plan for student coverage will be developed at all schools. This plan will result in the staggered start and end times and reduction of daily hours.

School-based Supply Accounts: All school based office supply and equipment line item accounts will be leveled funds for school year 2020. Schools are reviewing FY19 accounts for surplus funds to offset FY20 budgets.

District-wide Stipends: The district will review all stipends related to additional duties and advisors. Reductions may require impact bargaining with the Lunenburg Education Association.

Budget Documents

The following FY20 budget documents can be found on the Lunenburg Public Schools website at the link below.

- Superintendent's Proposed FY20 Budget, with executive summary and supporting data (12/19/18)
- Superintendent's Recommended FY20 Budget (4/3/19)
- School Department FY20 Budget Presentation to Finance Committee (3/14/19)
- Superintendent Budget Updates (2/6/19, 3/6/19)

<https://www.lunenburgschools.net/superintendent-of-schools/school-budgets>